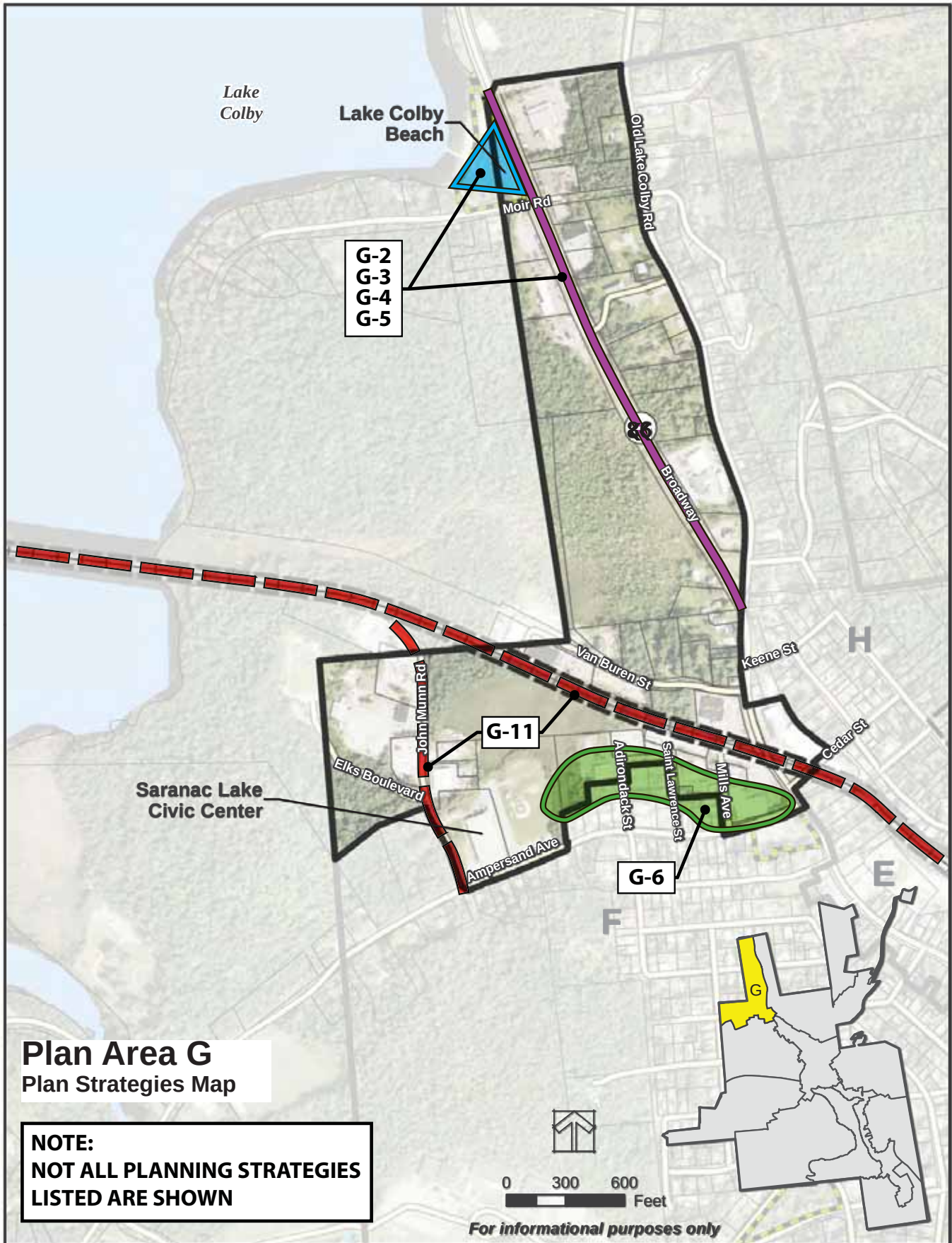




Village of Saranac Lake **Comprehensive Plan**

April 2013



This project is funded through the New York State Department of State with funds provided under Title 11 of the Environmental Protection Fund.

Plan Area G:

Planning Strategies:

1. Encourage the highest and best use of existing commercial parcels (for both new development and redevelopment) with design characteristics that complement the area as a gateway to the Village
2. Consider development of “form-based” design guidelines as part of the review process for new development and redevelopment of parcels fronting on NYS Route 86
3. Employ access management principles (defined access points, consolidated driveways, reduction of conflicting turning movements, etc.) during review of development/ redevelopment of private parcels on NYS Route 86
4. Upper Broadway (NYS Route 86) as a principal gateway to the Village should contain elements (improved entry signage, lighting, landscaping, streetscape design, etc.) that reflect a sense of arrival to the Village of Saranac Lake
5. Accommodate all modes of travel within the existing right-of-way of NYS Route 86 particularly for travelers seeking access to the Lake Colby recreation area off Moir Road
6. Protect the character and integrity of residential homes along Ampersand Avenue, Adirondack Street and St. Lawrence Street through maintenance of proper buffering and screening in areas adjoining non-residential uses
7. Consider allowance of limited home occupations
8. Require use of proper stormwater management, erosion control, and maintenance of existing vegetation
9. Consider well-planned signage and wayfinding to assist with the effective movement of people through this area
10. Extend the multi-modal rail/trail along the railroad corridor to Little Lake Colby
11. Consider establishing a trail linkage from the trails around Lake Colby to John Munn Road
12. Consider establishment of connections and linkages from the extended multi-purpose recreational trail in the railroad corridor to existing pathways where possible
13. Construct a canoe/kayak launch at Lake Colby beach



Flower along River Street.

The vision for the park was originally discussed in the 1908 Olmstead Plan and, therefore, has special meaning to the community. Presently, the park is primarily being used as community green space and a walking area. It is a year-round focal point in which to participate in the annual Saranac Lake Winter Carnival and view the summer and winter fireworks celebrations. There are picnic areas and open green space but no provision for public parking. Mountain Mist Park is a very small Village-owned “pocket park” located adjacent to the Mountain Mist food stand on Lake Flower Avenue. There are several picnic tables at this location. There is no public parking at the site. Most users are patrons of the adjacent privately-owned Custard Stand which provides boat access to the site. Baldwin Park is located adjacent to Lake Flower along Lake Flower Avenue. The Park has two tennis courts and three half basketball courts and a picnic table with a cooking grill. There is a Vietnam Veterans’ Memorial located in the Park. There is no formal designated parking at this location; therefore, very limited parking occurs on the street along Lake Flower Avenue. Baldwin Park is a highly desirable location from which to view Lake Flower and its surrounding environs. Access by cars and boats are issues of high priority. Since spring flooding tends to impact this area, careful consideration should be given regarding project design along the waterfront.

Lake Colby

Lake Colby is part of the Lake Champlain network and feeds into Lower Saranac Lake and the Saranac River. Lake Colby has a number of public facilities including DEC’s Camp Colby Environmental Education Camp, the Town of Harrietstown’s Latour Park, the Village of Saranac Lake’s only public swimming facility, several public camp sites, and a DEC boat launch. The Lake hosts only seven private shore owners with the remainder of the Lake being surrounded by public-use or forever wild lands.

William. J. Wallace Memorial Beach, located just north of the Village on NYS Route 86, offers users a beach, picnic area, and canoe access. The site has high scenic values and is the only public swimming area in the Village of Saranac Lake. There is the potential to improve the physical facility and programs that service the public. During the winter months, Lake Colby is actively used for ice fishing and has hosted winter ATV races and public ice skating in the past. Resources at Wallace Memorial Beach are supplemented by an adjacent strip of park land owned by the Town of Harrietstown and the DEC Boat Launch. Regarding the continued viability of the Lake as a recreational resource the primary issue at Lake Colby is invasive aquatic vegetation which consists primarily of Eurasian water-milfoil (EWM). In response the Lake Colby Association in 2002, initiated the Lake Colby Milfoil Eradication Project as a non-chemical control method for EWM.

Saranac River

The Saranac River is the forming influence of the downtown area as its location and orientation shaped the development pattern. It exits Lake Flower at Hydro Park and weaves through the Village through and behind the buildings of Main Street providing opportunities for fishing and watching whitewater canoe/kayak racing events. A pedestrian bridge linking Hydro Park and the Village parking lot was completed in 2002. The parking lot is also being considered as a location for a skate board park. A pedestrian path along the Saranac River links riverine habitats, cultural landscapes, historic sites and public parks to the main business district. The Saranac River Walk follows the



Flower along River Street.

The vision for the park was originally discussed in the 1908 Olmstead Plan and, therefore, has special meaning to the community. Presently, the park is primarily being used as community green space and a walking area. It is a year-round focal point in which to participate in the annual Saranac Lake Winter Carnival and view the summer and winter fireworks celebrations. There are picnic areas and open green space but no provision for public parking. Mountain Mist Park is a very small Village-owned “pocket park” located adjacent to the Mountain Mist food stand on Lake Flower Avenue. There are several picnic tables at this location. There is no public parking at the site. Most users are patrons of the adjacent privately-owned Custard Stand which provides boat access to the site. Baldwin Park is located adjacent to Lake Flower along Lake Flower Avenue. The Park has two tennis courts and three half basketball courts and a picnic table with a cooking grill. There is a Vietnam Veterans’ Memorial located in the Park. There is no formal designated parking at this location; therefore, very limited parking occurs on the street along Lake Flower Avenue. Baldwin Park is a highly desirable location from which to view Lake Flower and its surrounding environs. Access by cars and boats are issues of high priority. Since spring flooding tends to impact this area, careful consideration should be given regarding project design along the waterfront.

Lake Colby

Lake Colby is part of the Lake Champlain network and feeds into Lower Saranac Lake and the Saranac River. Lake Colby has a number of public facilities including DEC’s Camp Colby Environmental Education Camp, the Town of Harrietstown’s Latour Park, the Village of Saranac Lake’s only public swimming facility, several public camp sites, and a DEC boat launch. The Lake hosts only seven private shore owners with the remainder of the Lake being surrounded by public-use or forever wild lands.

William. J. Wallace Memorial Beach, located just north of the Village on NYS Route 86, offers users a beach, picnic area, and canoe access. The site has high scenic values and is the only public swimming area in the Village of Saranac Lake. There is the potential to improve the physical facility and programs that service the public. During the winter months, Lake Colby is actively used for ice fishing and has hosted winter ATV races and public ice skating in the past. Resources at Wallace Memorial Beach are supplemented by an adjacent strip of park land owned by the Town of Harrietstown and the DEC Boat Launch. Regarding the continued viability of the Lake as a recreational resource the primary issue at Lake Colby is invasive aquatic vegetation which consists primarily of Eurasian water-milfoil (EWM). In response the Lake Colby Association in 2002, initiated the Lake Colby Milfoil Eradication Project as a non-chemical control method for EWM.

Saranac River

The Saranac River is the forming influence of the downtown area as its location and orientation shaped the development pattern. It exits Lake Flower at Hydro Park and weaves through the Village through and behind the buildings of Main Street providing opportunities for fishing and watching whitewater canoe/kayak racing events. A pedestrian bridge linking Hydro Park and the Village parking lot was completed in 2002. The parking lot is also being considered as a location for a skate board park. A pedestrian path along the Saranac River links riverine habitats, cultural landscapes, historic sites and public parks to the main business district. The Saranac River Walk follows the



Attachment C - Comparison with Village LWRP

The Village of Saranac Lake LWRP – 2002		The Village of Saranac Lake Update of the Comprehensive Plan – 2012	
Proposed Projects/initiatives:		Proposed Projects/initiatives:	
Lake Colby	• Picnic pavilion • Handicapped fishing access • Formalize launching site • Landscaping • Develop four season plan • Enhance sidewalk and trails, etc. Est. total cost = \$325,000	Lake Colby	No change suggested.

